And it happened while Shubha was sitting a yard away from Mridula. Shubha didn't react. She watched Mridula's reaction for a while and left the room. Mridula could not wait for her husband to return. She took it up with Ranganath the moment he came home. Ranganath advised her not to raise the subject again, with the assurance that they would leave soon. Mridula reminded him of Suresh Master asking them for four days only and that those four days would be over that night. Ranganath had no reply to offer. However, Shubha tried to make it easier for Mridula. She spoke to her about her life and how eager she was to return to Jaffna and meet her supreme leader Prabhakaran to express gratitude.[2]

Mridula was uncomfortable with the developments. But she was gathering confidence to be able to deal with the situation. One evening, Sivarasan was cleaning his false eye when Mridula asked him why they killed Rajiv Gandhi. Shubha immediately chipped in with the stock reply that all assassins gave—Rajiv Gandhi was responsible for sending the IPKF to Sri Lanka and therefore responsible for all the atrocities the force had heaped upon innocent people, including women and children. But Sivarasan replied to Mridula. He asked her if she was satisfied with Shubha's answer. Mridula was not, but she didn't dare say that to the world's most-wanted fugitive at that point. She tried to change the subject to the cyanide capsule that hung around Shubha's neck. Mridula asked her if the capsule really did carry cyanide. Shubha's reply came attached with a sense of pride. She said it indeed did and that she would be proud to take it if the need arose. Mridula was stunned. Perhaps Sivarasan wanted the conversation to end there. He told Mridula quietly not to mention any of this to anyone outside, or the consequences would be fatal for her and her husband.[3]

On 16 August, Ranganath told Mridula that he had fixed a new house in Konanakunte for the group and that they would be leaving. But Ranganath and Mridula had to first go and set up the new house with 'provisions, drinking water, a gas cylinder and stove and toiletries' and then perform a puja for their well-being. Mridula prayed at the puja for a quick end to their ordeal. That night, when the group was leaving for Konanakunte, Mridula saw Nero carrying the AK-47 rifle and Shubha a pistol. She couldn't help